

TAB 13



Board of Education Report

File #: Rep-039-24/25, **Version:** 1

U.S. Environmental Protection Agency Clean School Bus Program Notice of Award
September 10, 2024
Transportation Services Division

Action Proposed:

Approval to accept award totaling \$19.75 million to offset the costs to purchase 50 electric school buses. The award is issued through the Environmental Protection Agency (EPA), an agency of the United States government tasked with human health and environmental protection matters. These new buses shall replace the oldest diesel buses in the District's fleet.

Background:

The EPA's Clean School Bus (CSB) Program was created through the 2021 Infrastructure Investment and Jobs Act to promote the use of low and zero-emission (electric) school buses to provide clean rides for students while prioritizing historically underserved communities that face disproportionate air pollution. The program's objective is to improve the air quality for communities across the United States by reducing air pollution and greenhouse gas (GHG) emissions while accelerating the deployment of clean school buses.

The electric buses emit zero emissions and are equipped with the latest safety features. They will have a capacity for 75 passengers and an operating range of 125 miles with a full charge.

The proposed award supports the District's resolution, "Transitioning Los Angeles Unified School District to 100% Clean, Renewable Energy Resulting in Healthier Students and More Sustainable, Equitable Communities (Res-018-19/0)." It further supports the Healthy Breathing initiative adopted by the Board of Education in 2003 to reduce the harmful effects of diesel emissions to students and the school community.

Expected Outcomes:

The replacement of 50 diesel school buses with zero-emission electric school buses will reduce over 530 short tons of CO₂ annually along school bus routes. This will mitigate students' risk of exposure to harmful air pollutants and carcinogens, especially for students who reside in impacted communities. Besides eliminating harmful emissions and improving the air quality, electric buses will yield lower operational costs than conventional buses. Electric buses require fewer components, such as fan belts, air filters, and oil, to operate. Studies have shown that electric buses are also more fuel efficient, resulting in fuel savings of as much as \$70,000 over a lifecycle of 20 years. Upon the delivery of these buses, the District will have over 300 electric buses in its fleet.

Board Options and Consequences:

A "NO" vote - the District would forfeit the award to offset the purchase costs of electric buses and forgo the environmental benefits and reduced operational costs.

A "YES" vote - the District shall accept the award and use them in conjunction with General Funds to replace 50 diesel buses with new electric buses, resulting in reductions of operational costs and GHG emission levels

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for healthier air quality for the community.

Policy Implications:

Not Applicable

Budget Impact:

This is a one-time grant award of \$19.75 million to offset 86% of the cost to purchase 50 new electric school buses. At approximately \$420,000 each, the total cost is approximately \$23 million, including tax. Transportation Services Division shall seek Board approval to fund the remaining 14% of the cost, or approximately \$3.25 million.

A breakdown of cost estimates is provided below:

Line Item	Total Cost of Buses (50 buses at \$420K ea.)	Tax (9.5%)	Total Costs	EPA Funding	LAUSD Costs
Class 8 zero-emission/electric school bus	\$21,000,000	\$1,995,000	\$22,995,000	\$19,750,000	\$3,245,000

Student Impact:

The grant award will directly benefit students by enabling the District's Transportation Services Division to improve the timely delivery of students to schools. New buses have significantly fewer breakdowns, which reduces repair down-times and transportation delays. The zero emission buses will improve student health by limiting their exposure to transportation-related air pollution.

Equity Impact:

Component	Score	Score Rationale
Recognition	3	This award will support the District's efforts to transition to 100% clean renewable energy resulting in healthier students by limiting their exposure to harmful pollutants and creating more equitable communities. This will also directly benefit students by improving the timely delivery of students to schools as new buses have significantly fewer breakdowns.
Resource Prioritization	3	The new, zero-emission electric school buses will benefit all students as they will contribute to improve the overall route coverage for all students in the District.
Results	3	These electric school buses will help ensure students get to school on time every day, so they have the opportunity to learn.
TOTAL	9	

Issues and Analysis:

Not Applicable

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Attachments:

Not Applicable

Informatives:

Not Applicable

Submitted:

08/12/24

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RESPECTFULLY SUBMITTED,


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☒ Approved as to budget impact statement.